

Diet for Diabetic Patients: Recommended Foods, Foods to Avoid, and Dietary Targets

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Background

Diet is a main part of diabetes treatment for all people with diabetes. The best diet is not one rigid plan, but an individualized, balanced eating pattern that supports blood sugar, weight, blood pressure, and blood fats. (5 sources)

Diet therapy is a basic part of care in diabetes, no matter the type, and it works best when it is built as a balanced eating pattern rather than a special or extreme “diabetic diet.” ([Todorovic et al., 2022](#)) ([Reza et al., 2018](#)) In practice, meal plans are usually individualized to the person’s body size, target weight, energy use, physical activity, culture, ethnicity, eating habits, insulin regimen, and any other health problems. ([Kabadi, 2021](#)) ([Nishida et al., 2024](#)) This is because the main goals of dietary treatment are broad: keep blood glucose near target, support healthy body weight, and help control blood pressure and blood lipids while still providing enough calories and overall nutritional balance. ([Luzak et al., 2026](#)) ([Nishida et al., 2024](#)) Across sources, some general themes stay consistent even when exact macronutrient ratios differ: avoid refined sugar and limit saturated fat, choose healthier fats and fiber-rich foods, and plan meals in a structured way that fits the person’s daily life. ([Kabadi, 2021](#)) ([Reza et al., 2018](#)) ([Nishida et al., 2024](#)) ([Luzak et al., 2026](#))

Evidence

([Todorovic et al., 2022](#))

[Nutrition in pregnancy with diabetes mellitus](#)

"Implementing a proper diet is the basis of treatment for all people with diabetes, regardless of the type of disease. We use the ADA (American Dietetic Association) system for calculating the needs for macronutrients and energy intake. Food is divided into six groups. Each group contains foods with the same characteristics of composition and energy value. The only differences are in the weight of the foods in the same group. The schedule of meals is important so that the smallest time gap between meals is four hours. The portion of carbohydrates in meals should be balanced. It is important to eat less fat, especially cholesterol. It is recommended to avoid frying, baking, and frying food. Food should be prepared by stewing, boiling, baking in foil, on the grill, and using as little fat as possible (Power, 2006)"

"Foods that should be avoided except in the treatment of hypoglycemia are sugar, honey, chocolate, sweets, drinks with sugar, and all foods with simple carbohydrates (monosaccharides and disaccharides). These foods are easily resorbed and cause an increase in glycemia after a meal.

Other foods to avoid are alcohol and animal fats. Foods that can be taken in smaller quantities are fats of plant origin"

([Reza et al., 2018](#))

[Socio-demographic characteristics, dietary habits and physical activity influence on nutritional status of the diabetics: a cross sectional study](#)

"A proper diet is a fundamental element of therapy in all diabetic individuals. A diet recommended for a diabetic patient is, in fact a "balanced diet" for anyone. A balanced meal is a combination of carbohydrates, fats, proteins and fibers appropriate for the individual. A diet plan should be individualized according to his/her needs; it must be simple to understand and easy to follow"

"In consideration of the composition of the diet, besides a low saturated (high carbohydrate diet, a high monounsaturated fat diet may also be recommended (Garg, 1996). Intake of trans-fatty acids and cholesterol should be restricted and alcohol should be completely avoided in diabetic with dyslipidemia. Protein intakes should be between 15-20% of the total energy intake. Fiber rich sources of complex carbohydrates are preferred over refined sugars. The diet should be wholesome and provide the dietary allowances of all vitamins and minerals (www.bamboweb, 2005)."

(Kabadi, 2021)

Non-Insulin Therapeutic Option in Management of Diabetes: Life Style Modification: Diet and Exercise

"However, recommendations to avoid ingestion of refined sugar and saturated fats have remained consistent. Finally, diabetic diets are being formulated by nutritionists based on ethnicity, nationality, culture and eating habits of the individual. Caloric content is based on the patient's body build, weight, energy needs and physical activity and may be adjusted according to individual eating habits, type of insulin regimen, and metabolic derangements. The proportion of caloric sources (fat, carbohydrate, protein) may be altered depending on the presence of secondary disorders. Several small daily meals, including a bedtime snack, are advised."

(Nishida et al., 2024)

The Up-to-date Treatment for Diabetes and Prevention of its Complications

"Diet therapy is important to maintain adequate caloric intake and nutritional balance. It is recommended that meal plans be based on target body weight and energy expenditure, which varies from patient to patient. An appropriate balance of carbohydrates, protein, and lipids should be maintained. However, a proper balance between those nutrients is still in debate 5) . Fiber intake and sodium restriction are also important in the diabetic's diet. Salt intake should be reduced to prevent hypertension and decrease the risk of atherosclerosis. Healthy fat choices and fiber-rich foods are also recommended."

(Luzak et al., 2026)

Good Dietary Control Significantly Improves Anthropometric and Metabolic Parameters and Liver Function in Patients with Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus—A Pilot Study

"According to the Standards of Care in Diabetes recommended by the Polish Diabetes Society, the goal of dietary treatment for individuals with diabetes is to maintain normoglycemia, optimal blood pressure values and serum lipid and lipoprotein levels, and appropriate body weight, and these targets can be achieved using individually calculated caloric intake, distribution of calories among daily meals, selection of food sources providing necessary energy, vitamins, minerals, and phytochemicals, and moderation of products whose consumption should be limited (Araszkiewicz et al., 2024)"

"patients who follow a diet excluding monosaccharides and added sugars and increasing dietary fiber intake, and who are under the regular care of a dietitian, achieve improvements in anthropometric and biochemical parameters."

Recommended diet pattern and core foods to prioritize

The most supported approach is a balanced, mostly whole-food eating pattern built around non-starchy vegetables, legumes, whole grains, fruits, nuts, seeds, and healthier fats. Mediterranean-style, plant-forward, high-fiber, and lower-glycemic eating patterns are commonly recommended, but the exact mix should be tailored to the person. (20 sources)

- **Use an overall whole-food, high-fiber eating pattern rather than a "special" diabetic menu.** Commonly recommended patterns include Mediterranean, vegetarian or plant-based, DASH, lower-carbohydrate, and fiber-rich diets, as long as they are individualized and centered on minimally processed foods. ([Yeh et al., 2023](#)) ([Chon, 2023](#)) ([Peride et al., 2024](#))
- **Make non-starchy vegetables a main part of most meals.** Guidance repeatedly emphasizes vegetables, especially non-starchy vegetables, as a core food group for people with diabetes. ([Yeh et al., 2023](#)) ([Magusood et al., 2024](#)) ([Lee et al., 2025](#)) ([Abaza et al., 2017](#))
- **Choose carbohydrates mainly from fiber-rich sources.** Better carbohydrate choices include whole grains, legumes, vegetables, fruits, and low-fat dairy rather than refined starches. ([Vissek et al., 2012](#)) ([Chon, 2023](#)) ([Duarte et al., 2020](#)) ([Forouhi et al., 2018](#))
- **Prioritize whole grains and other lower-GI starches.** Wholemeal products, pasta, beans, lentils, and other lower-glycemic carbohydrate foods are often preferred over higher-GI staples. ([Vissek et al., 2012](#)) ([Guo et al., 2020](#)) ([Ley et al., 2014](#)) ([Soh et al., 2023](#))
- **Include legumes often.** Beans, peas, and lentils are consistently listed among the best foods to build

meals around because they provide carbohydrate with fiber and plant protein. ([Vissek et al., 2012](#)) ([Boer et al., 2020](#)) ([Tatoli et al., 2022](#))

- **Eat fruit, but prefer whole fruit over juice.** Whole fruit is recommended as part of a diabetes diet, while juice is less favored because it gives sugar and calories with little or no fiber. ([Vissek et al., 2012](#)) ([Kumar, 2019](#)) ([Tatoli et al., 2022](#))
- **Use nuts, seeds, and other plant foods regularly.** Nuts and seeds are commonly recommended because they add fiber, unsaturated fats, and satiety. ([Vissek et al., 2012](#)) ([Chakraborty, 2020](#)) ([Buowari, 2021](#)) ([Lee et al., 2025](#))
- **Favor healthy fats, especially unsaturated fats.** Olive oil, peanut or canola oil, olives, avocado, nuts, seeds, and other sources of mono- and polyunsaturated fats are preferred over animal fats and other saturated fats. ([Vissek et al., 2012](#)) ([Chakraborty, 2020](#)) ([Chrysohoou et al., 2023](#)) ([Chon, 2023](#))
- **Include leaner protein choices.** Plant proteins, beans, nuts, seeds, fish, skinless poultry, and low-fat dairy are commonly suggested as better routine protein options. ([Chakraborty, 2020](#)) ([Boer et al., 2020](#)) ([Iizuka et al., 2023](#)) ([Abaza et al., 2017](#))
- **Mediterranean-style eating is a notable example of a good fit for many patients.** This pattern emphasizes olive oil, fish, fruits, vegetables, legumes, and high-fiber unprocessed cereals, with most carbohydrate coming from complex sources and saturated fat kept low. ([Chrysohoou et al., 2023](#))
- **A plant-forward approach can also work well.** Reviews describe diets built around fruits, vegetables, legumes, whole grains, nuts, and seeds, with low sugar, low salt, and low intake of highly processed foods, as helpful options for diabetes care. ([Buowari, 2021](#)) ([Balwan et al., 2022](#))
- **Practical daily targets often focus on vegetables, fruit, legumes, and fiber.** Some sources suggest at least 4–5 servings of fruits and vegetables per day, at least 5 portions of fruits and vegetables daily, and regular legume intake such as about 4 portions per week. ([Kumar, 2019](#)) ([Tatoli et al., 2022](#))

Evidence

([Yeh et al., 2023](#))

[Diet and exercise are a fundamental part of comprehensive care for type 2 diabetes](#)

"These recommendations emphasize the importance of consuming non-starchy vegetables, minimizing the intake of added sugars and refined grain, and opting for whole foods instead of highly processed foods"

"There are also several eating patterns that have been proposed for individuals with type 2 diabetes mellitus. These include the Mediterranean diet, low-carbohydrate diet, fiber-rich diet, intermittent very-low-calorie diet, and vegetarian or plant-based diet (Table 1) [7][8][9][10][11][12][13][14][15][16]"

"Excessive alcohol intake should be avoided in individuals with type 2 diabetes mellitus due to several reasons. First, it increases the risk of hypoglycemia in patients with type 2 diabetes mellitus. Furthermore, alcohol consumption has been associated with impaired fasting glucose in non-diabetic individuals. This suggests that alcohol may disrupt glucose homeostasis and lead to fluctuations in blood glucose levels [7,17]."

([Chon, 2023](#))

[Medical nutrition therapy for diabetes mellitus](#)

"A Mediterranean, vegetarian, low-fat, low-carbohydrate, and Dietary Approaches to Stop Hypertension diet may be used based on individualized plans and priorities. Patients with diabetes are recommended to consume carbohydrates from fiber-rich whole grains, legumes, vegetables, raw fruits, and dairy products and to reduce intake of sweetened beverages"

"Patients with diabetes are recommended to replace foods high in saturated and trans fatty acids with foods rich in unsaturated fatty acids. Routine administration of unsaturated fatty acid supplements is not recommended. Sodium intake should not exceed 2,300 mg/day."

(Peride et al., 2024)

The Key Role of Nutritional Intervention in Delaying Disease Progression and the Therapeutic Management of Diabetic Kidney Disease—A Challenge for Physicians and Patients

"The management of patients with diabetic nephropathy can be improved by implementing diets such as Dietary Approaches to Stop Hypertension (DASH) and the Mediterranean diet (MED) which both emphasize higher intake of vegetables, whole grains (e.g., complex and unrefined carbohydrates), and plant-based protein (e.g., nuts, seeds, and beans)"

"There are other aspects, such as the high phosphorus and potassium content of the recommended foods, that limit the use of the DASH diet in DKD patients"

"The MED recommends high intake of olive oil and plant foods, such as unrefined cereals, significant amounts of vegetables, fresh fruits, etc."

(Maqusood et al., 2024)

Navigating Cardiovascular Risk in Type 1 Diabetes: A Comprehensive Review of Strategies for Prevention and Management

"A T1DM diet should emphasize reasonable glycemic control, BP management, lipid level reduction, and a healthy lifestyle through diet and exercise, featuring healthful protein foods, non-starchy vegetables, nuts, seeds, beans, legumes, whole grains, healthful fats, and adequate hydration while avoiding or limiting added sugars, refined grains, processed foods, sugary beverages, fried foods, and high-fat alcoholic beverages [19]."

(Lee et al., 2025)

Lifestyle prescriptions for diabetes management in primary care: a narrative review

"Guidance should emphasize non-starchy vegetables, fruits, legumes, lean protein, whole grains, nuts, and seeds, while minimizing red meat, sugar-sweetened beverages, and processed foods"

"Sodium intake should be limited to less than 2,300 mg per day, which should be achieved primarily through the reduction of processed food consumption"

"Patients with diabetes should preferably avoid alcohol consumption; if consumed, recommended limits should be followed"

"Sugar-sweetened beverages should be limited, and the consumption of water without nonnutritive sweeteners is recommended."

(Abaza et al., 2017)

SMS education for the promotion of diabetes self-management in low & middle income countries: a pilot randomized controlled trial in Egypt

"A healthy diet for diabetic patients is generally the same as a healthy diet for anyone; low in fat, moderate in salt and sugar, with meals based on lean protein, non-starchy vegetables, whole grains, and fruit"

"Avoid sugary drinks like regular soda, fruit punch, fruit drinks, energy drinks, sweet tea, etc. These will raise your blood glucose and provide several hundred calories in just one serving!"

(Vissek et al., 2012)

Comparison of a low-glycemic index vs standard diabetic diet.

"For carbohydrates, whole grains, legumes (beans, peas and lentils), fruits, vegetables and low-fat dairy products were recommended. Fibre-rich foods including vegetables, fruits, nuts, legumes, whole-wheat flour and wheat bran were advised with fibre intake at least 20 g per day, as well foods containing monounsaturated and polyunsaturated fats, such as walnuts, olives, olive and peanut oil, avocados, almonds. Reduced intake of saturated fats, trans fats (saturated fat intake should be <7% of total calories 10), cholesterol (aim for no more than 200 mg of cholesterol per day) and sodium (aim for less than 4 g of sodium per day) was requested"

"This group was advised to eat pasta, legumes, and wholemeal products, and at the same time, they were advised to avoid food with higher GI, such as potatoes and white bread."

(Duarte et al., 2020)

Phytopharmacological Strategies in the Management of Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus

"There is unanimity on the importance of body weight control, reduction of energy intake coupled with exercise, and healthy diet with low intake of processed foods (rich on refined sugars and flour) and high consumption of whole grains, fiber, polyunsaturated fatty acids, fruits, vegetables, and low-fat dairy products for the control and prevention of T2DM [2](Lee et al., 2010)(Forouhi et al., 2018)"

"Processed red meat belongs to the group of foods to be avoided by the patient with T2DM"

"The group of forbidden foods for those with T2DM also includes refined grains and sugars (high glycemic index). Preference should be given to the consumption of whole grains (low glycemic index), and, above all, fiber, with a higher consumption being recommended for T2DM patients (50 g per day) than for healthy individuals (30 g per day) (Sharifuddin et al., 2015)(Forouhi et al., 2018)."

(Forouhi et al., 2018)

Dietary and nutritional approaches for prevention and management of type 2 diabetes

"Common ground on dietary approaches for the prevention, management, and potential remission of type 2 diabetes can be found, argue Nita G Forouhi and colleagues"

(Guo et al., 2020)

The Role of Nutrition in the Prevention and Intervention of Type 2 Diabetes

"To better improve glucose control in T2D patients, diets rich in fruits, vegetables, legumes, and whole grains are recommended. Lowcarbohydrate, low-GI (glycemic index), and high-protein diet patterns will protect us from hyperglycemia incidence. Moreover, moderate consumption of nuts and alcohol is also beneficial (Ley et al., 2014)."

(Ley et al., 2014)

Prevention and Management of Type 2 Diabetes: Dietary Components and Nutritional Strategies

"Summary In the past couple of decades, evidence from prospective observational studies and clinical trials has converged to support the importance of individual nutrients, foods, and dietary patterns in the prevention and management of type 2 diabetes. The quality of dietary fats and carbohydrates consumed is more crucial than the quantity of these macronutrients. Diets rich in whole grains, fruits, vegetables, legumes, nuts, moderate in alcohol consumption, and lower in refined grains, red/processed meats, and sugar-sweetened beverages have demonstrated to reduce diabetes risk and improve glycemic control and blood lipids in patients with diabetes. Several healthful dietary patterns emphasizing the overall diet quality can be adapted to appropriate personal and cultural food preferences and calorie needs for weight control and diabetes prevention and management. Although considerable progress has been made in developing and implementing evidence-based nutrition recommendations in developed countries, concerted global efforts and policies are warranted to alleviate regional disparities."

(Soh et al., 2023)

Functional foods of sub-Saharan Africa and their implications in the management of type 2 diabetes: A review

"Patients with diabetes are advised to eat a variety of fiber-rich foods including, fruits, vegetables, legumes, and whole grains (ADA, 2019). They could eat foods rich in resistant starch or starch with a high percentage of amylose, all of which are poor in simple sugars and fats. Diabetic patients need to be especially careful about the kinds and amounts of carbohydrates they eat because high-carbohydrate meals can quickly raise blood sugar levels. This is why understanding the glycemic index (GI) of foods is important. Low-GI foods are recommended for people with diabetes because they have a positive effect on postprandial blood glucose levels (Bantle et al., 2008). Fats are an essential part of the diet, but it is important to consume healthy fats, such as monounsaturated and polyunsaturated fats, and limit saturated and trans fats."

(Boer et al., 2020)

Kidney Disease: Improving Global Outcomes (KDIGO) New Guideline for Diabetes Management in Chronic Kidney Disease: A Meet-the-Expert Session

"patients with diabetes and CKD should consume an individualised diet high in vegetables, fruits, whole grains, fibre, legumes, plant-based proteins, unsaturated fats, and nuts, but lower in processed meats, refined carbohydrates, and sweetened beverages."

(Tatoli et al., 2022)

Dietary Patterns Associated with Diabetes in an Older Population from Southern Italy Using an Unsupervised Learning Approach

"According to the recommendations of the Italian Society of Diabetology (SID), fruits, vegetables, legumes, and whole grains should never be lacking in a diabetic diet. They are rich in fiber, micronutrients, and phytochemicals, and they ensure good control of blood sugar, triglycerides, and body weight (Joshipura et al., 2001)(Sargeant et al., 2001). The consumption of at least five portions of fruits and vegetables per day and four portions of legumes per week should introduce the right amount of fiber for good glycemic control"

". In the diabetic subjects, the consumption of fruits, vegetables, and nuts was higher than in the "Not Diabetic" group, while the consumption of red meat, processed meat, and ready-to-eat dishes was lower."

(Kumar, 2019)

Knowledge, Attitude and Awareness of Diabetes Nutrition in Physicians

"A regular and balanced diet helps in a better glycemic control in type 1 and Type 2 diabetes"

". Fruit juices are a rich source of calories without fiber and with relatively high glycemic index. Hence, it is better to avoid fruit juices in diabetic patients. It is also suggested that a diabetic patient should consume the whole fruit with skin, instead of fruit pulp /juices. Ideally, minimum of four or five servings per day of fruits and vegetables is recommended (i.e., approximately 400-500 g/day including three vegetable and two fruit portions [e.g., 100 g of (one katori) raw vegetables (e.g., cauliflower, brinjal, etc.) = 20-30 Kcal; 100 g of fruit e.g., one apple=59 Kcal]) [8]. Dry fruits also should be made a part of daily diet wherever possible, as these encourage a rise of HDL, are a very rich source of high-quality protein and do have a very low glycemic index and therefore do not add to rising glycemia"

". In this survey, majority of the doctors agreed on avoiding sweet items and food item with high glycemic index."

(Chakraborty, 2020)

Nutrition And Physical Exercise For The Prevention And Management Of Diabetes

"Mono and polyunsaturated fats (e.g., olive oil, canola oil, nuts/ seeds, avocado), fatty fish (particularly those are high in omega-3 fatty acids e.g., salmon, herring, trout, Sardines, fresh tuna), skinless poultry, nonfat or low-fat dairy, and legumes while considered good to consume; sugary beverages, trans fats, dried fruits are not recommended for diabetic people [17]. Beef, pork, lamb and high-fat dairy products (e.g., cream cheese, whole milk or yogurt), as they contain high saturated fat and may be associated with increased cardiovascular risk are also not recommended either."

(Buowari, 2021)

The Role of Lifestyle Medicine in the Management of Diabetes Mellitus

"healthy eating which includes a whole plant-based diet, low fat, low sugar and low salt"

". Consumption of a whole plant-based diet involves eating food rich in fruits, vegetables, and legumes. Fruits, vegetables and legumes are available globally and should be encouraged. Good nutrition is very important in any lifestyle intervention [24]. In whole food plant-based diet, consumption of fruits, legumes, whole grains, including nuts and seeds are emphasized. Also, the consumption of animal products and unhealthy foods such as red and white meat, poultry, fish, eggs, dairy products, refined and processed meal, added sugars and oils are minimized and if possible eliminated from the diet (Kelly et al., 2020)"

". To fill up the satiety while consuming low calories, complex carbohydrates with a low glycaemic index should be consumed."

(Chrysohoou et al., 2023)

Cardiometabolic Care: Assessing Patients with Diabetes Mellitus with No Overt Cardiovascular Disease in the Light of Heart Failure Development Risk

"The intake of saturated fats should be reduced, while trans fat intake should be eliminated. A decrease in energy density is also recommended (<125 kcal per 100 g of food), while food should be enriched with whole grains, vegetables, nuts, poultry, legumes and vegetable oils [52]"

". The diet consists mainly of olive oil, fish, fruits, vegetables, legumes, and high-fiber unprocessed cereals. Thus, it is rich in monounsaturated and polyunsaturated fatty acids, fiber and antioxidants, while the intake of saturated fat is limited, and the amount of carbohydrate intake comes mainly from complex carbohydrates. All the above nutritional factors seem to contribute to a better control of glucose levels in patients with diabetes (Mtintsilana et al., 2019)(Abdurahman et al., 2018)(Park et al., 2018)(Kouvari et al., 2022)(Kouvari et al., 2022)(Kosti et al., 2022)(Pan et al., 2015)."

(Iizuka et al., 2023)

Dietary and Nutritional Guidelines for People with Diabetes

"Regarding eating patterns, it is important to combine a variety of foods. In particular, it is recommended to avoid added sugars and refined grains and to choose whole foods instead of ultra-processed foods. Additionally, because most evidence shows that reducing the total amount of carbohydrates improves blood glucose, it is acceptable to choose a dietary pattern (e.g., Mediterranean diet) that is appropriate for each individual. It is also recommended that sugar-sweetened beverages should be replaced with water"

". Finally, in terms of preventing complications, it is recommended to reduce carbohydrates, switch from foods containing saturated fatty acids to foods containing unsaturated fatty acids, limit salt, and consume fish twice a week."

(Balwan et al., 2022)

Burden of Diabetes and Role of Medicinal Plants in Its Treatment

"The diet frequently recommended for people who suffer from diabetes is one that is high in dietary fibre, especially soluble fibre, but low in fat (especially saturated fat) and sugar. Highly processed, calorie-dense, nutrient depleted diet leads to exaggerated increase in blood glucose and lipids that induces immediate oxidative stress (Hu, 2011)(Pal et al., 2010)(Balwan et al., 2021)(Balwan et al., 2021)[15]."

Foods and dietary components to limit or avoid

People with diabetes are usually advised to limit foods that raise blood sugar quickly and foods that add excess calories, saturated fat, salt, or sugar. In practice, this means cutting back on sugary drinks, sweets, refined grains and starches, and heavily processed high-fat foods. (5 sources)

- **Avoid sugary drinks and other fast-absorbing sugars.** Sweetened drinks, sweets, chocolate, and other isolated sources of rapidly absorbed sugar can raise blood glucose quickly and are commonly advised against except for treating hypoglycemia. ([Thomas, 1983](#)) ([Sripada et al., 2019](#))
- **Limit refined starches and low-fiber grain foods.** White bread, pastries, refined flour products, and other fiber-poor starches are commonly discouraged, while wholemeal or whole-grain versions are preferred. ([Thomas, 1983](#)) ([Sripada et al., 2019](#))
- **Be careful with high-glycemic-index carbohydrate foods.** Foods with a high glycemic index can raise blood glucose rapidly, so carbohydrate choices are often guided by GI and portion control. ([Fatmah, 2020](#))
- **Do not let staple starch portions get too large.** Some guidance specifically says staple foods should not be excessive and total daily calories should be controlled. ([Li, 2021](#))
- **Keep added sugar low.** A “light” diet pattern with less sugar is repeatedly recommended for diabetes care. ([Li, 2021](#))
- **Limit high-fat foods, especially less healthy fats.** Guidance commonly recommends a lower-fat eating pattern overall, which fits with earlier advice in this summary to favor unsaturated fats over heavier, more energy-dense fat sources. ([Li, 2021](#))
- **Limit salt.** Some recommendations also advise eating with less salt as part of an overall diabetes-friendly diet pattern. ([Li, 2021](#))
- **Use caution with fruit juice and very sweet fruit forms.** Whole fruit is generally a better choice than juice, and some sources advise being selective about higher-sugar fruit choices and portions. ([Sripada et al., 2019](#))
- **Treat older advice to avoid all starches or all sugars with caution.** Historical sources sometimes recommended very strict avoidance of starch and sugars altogether, but this is much more restrictive than modern individualized meal planning. ([1893](#))

Evidence

(Thomas, 1983)

[New Facets of Diabetic Diets](#)

"Isolated sources of rapidly absorbed mono- and disaccharides (sweets, chocolate, sweetened drinks) should be excluded from the diet except in cases of illness or hypoglycaemic emergency.

Refined (i.e. fibre-free) starch-based foods should be used sparingly.

These objectives can be achieved by eating a high-fibre breakfast cereal such as Weetabix, Shredded Wheat or All-Bran instead of low-fibre products such as Cornflakes or Rice Krispies; eating wholemeal bread instead of white bread; using wholemeal flour for baking instead of white flour; using brown rice or pasta instead of their refined equivalents, and eating more fruit, vegetables, pulses and beans."

(Sripada et al., 2019)

[NON PHARMACOLOGICAL APPROACHES IN THE MANAGEMENT OF DIABETES MELLITUS](#)

"carbohydrate foods with lower glycemic index such as starchy food such as wholemeal parts and whole grains, pulses, brown rice

or wild rice, and brown bread are to be selected. White bread, oatmeal, and pastries are to be avoided. Prefer green leafy vegetables rich in fiber; avoid carbohydrate-rich fruits such as apple and fleshy fruits because they contain fructose"

".Avoid sugar drinks because they increase blood glucose levels. Instead prefer sugar-free or low sugar quenchers and fizzy drinks in minute quantity. In the dietary management of type-II diabetes, low carbohydrate intake, i.e., 30 g/day is advisable. In vegetarians, the incidence of diabetes is low. Thereby vegetarian diet is more effective in case of type-II diabetes and obesity"

".To balance the overall diet, prefer fruits and vegetables which are rich in vitamins and fibers every day. Fibrous strands admixed with flesh containing fruits such as citrus fruits do not increase the blood sugar level in case of moderate intake (Garg et al., 1994) (Kiehm et al., 1976)(Bantle et al., 2006)(Nielsen et al., 2006)[21][22](Widanagamage et al., 2009)."

(Fatmah, 2020)

Effects of High-Fiber Biscuits on Lipid and Anthropometric Profile of Patients with Type 2 Diabetes.

"Patients with DM are recommended to regulate their caloric, carbohydrate, fat, and protein intake in the seven groups of food classification. One way to regulate food or diet is by choosing the amount and type of appropriate carbohydrates on the basis of the glycemic index (GI). Foods containing high GI increase blood glucose level rapidly after consumption. Foods high in gluten, such as flour, should be avoided by patients with DM because they can increase blood glucose levels."

(Li, 2021)

Guidelines and standards for comprehensive clinical diagnosis and interventional treatment for diabetic foot in China (Issue 7.0)

"Inform patients that the diabetic diet should be regular and quantitative; total daily calories should be controlled; staple food should not be excessive; and the diet should be light, with low fat, less salt, less sugar, a small number of meals, and balanced nutrition."

(1893)

Notes on the Treatment of Diabetes Mellitus

"The regulation of the diet is the main and all-important factor in the treatment of diabetes. The object to be attained is to give as great a variety of food as possible, while prohibiting the use of starch, and cane or grape sugar, and the substances which contain them. Almost all kinds of animal food may be eaten by patients suffering from diabetes. Consequently, flesh, fish, and fowl are allowable ; but liver and edible molluscs, such as mussels, cockles, &c., must be forbidden."